

THE NINE CHECKS · CASE 03 / NIKHIL

Aangan Studio, Pune · Unanswered enquiries · Build scope: incoming phone calls only

MESA · AI and its Application · Cohort C4

First principles: what must be true before we automate?

1. The job

Answer every enquiry call, find out if it is worth a designer's time, and pass it on with everything already asked.

2. The facts

~200 enquiries/month; ~48% unanswered in 48 h; ~33% outside 10am–7pm; 2-person desk; <1 h reply converts 4x; project ₹8–14 lakh.

3. The rules we must obey

qualified.md (5 criteria), services.md (scope, Pune/PCMC, 6-week lead time), pricing.md (no number may ever be quoted).

4. Where the human stays

Pricing, the consultation, complaints from existing clients, and the final fit decision.

#	CHECK	EVIDENCE FROM THE CASE	RESULT
KILL SWITCHES · any NO = do not build			
01	Problem Real Documented, ongoing pain?	Nikhil pulled his own numbers: ~48% of ~200 enquiries a month get no response within 48 hours, and an answer within 1 hour converts 4x better than next day. Transcripts show it live: T08 missed at 10:47pm, T16 never logged, T07 left with no details taken.	PASS
02	Workflow Repeated Does it recur regularly?	~200 enquiries every month; 20 of the 40 September transcripts are phone calls asking the same questions (what, where, size, when, who decides).	PASS
03	Input Available Inputs exist and accessible now?	The caller's own words on the call, plus enquiries/ (40 transcripts), services.md, pricing.md and qualified.md, all provided. The voice line is available through a voice-AI platform (Vaani: WebRTC now, phone number when bought).	PASS
SIZING · any NO = build something smaller			
04	Output Valuable Would someone act on it?	Designers act on a complete handoff note instead of "a forwarded message with no context"; Nikhil acts on the numbers he today pulls by hand; callers get an answer at any hour.	PASS
05	Impact Measurable Trackable with a number?	Time to answer, % answered within 5 minutes, qualified / closed / escalated counts, time for a designer to claim the lead, consultations booked, and cost per call, all logged per call on the dashboard.	PASS
08	ROI Worth It Benefit clearly beats cost?	Voice ~₹5.50/min plus ~₹0.4 of AI analysis per call; hosting, database and CRM on free tiers. At 200 calls a month this is a few thousand rupees, against an average project of ₹8–14 lakh: one extra won project pays for many months.	PASS
BOUNDARY · any NO = build the tool, the human stays here			
06	Failure Risk OK If the AI is wrong, what happens?	Wrong qualification is recoverable: every closed call is logged and reviewable, and unclear calls go to a call-back. A wrong price is not recoverable: pricing.md says pricing is "indicative only, varies by site" and no number may be quoted; a figure on an ₹8–14 lakh decision anchors the customer.	NO for pricing
07	Judgment Protected Human review before anything consequential?	The AI only answers, collects and forwards. The designer claims the lead, runs the consultation and owns the price; senior staff own existing-client complaints (T09). Nothing is promised or quoted by the AI.	PASS

09 Owner Clear

One person
accountable?

Nikhil: he wrote qualified.md ("This is my rubric"), the rules in the system mirror it, and the dashboard lists every decision so he can correct the rubric.

PASS

THE CUT: quoting per-square-foot pricing

Nikhil asked: *"the system should be able to quote our standard per-square-foot pricing so people don't have to wait for that."*

Check 06 (Failure Risk) stops it, with 07 behind it: pricing.md forbids any number, range or "starts at" figure, and pricing is confirmed by the assigned designer at the consultation. **What we built instead:** the agent gives the approved line ("Pricing depends on the site, the materials you choose, and the scope; your designer will walk you through it at the consultation") and offers to book it; asking about price never disqualifies a caller. Code audits every transcript and alerts if a figure ever slips.

Sources: Case 03 problem statement; qualified.md; services.md; pricing.md; enquiries (T01–T20 phone, W01–W10, F01–F10). Verdict: **BUILD**: all kill switches and sizing checks pass; one boundary (pricing) stays with a human.